

Tyler's Playbook: Lessons, Don'ts and What to Learn

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This goes with your 5-week plan. I've pulled it from people who've built real businesses doing the pieces of what you're doing: automation agencies, local business marketing and Google profiles. Two honest notes first. Nobody publishes an exact playbook for "review replies in Leicester," so I've taken the lessons that carry over. And the big revenue numbers below are what these people say about themselves; I can't check their bank accounts.

What the people already winning did

Person	What they built (their own claims)	What they did at the start	What you copy
Nick Saraev	Make.com automation agency (LeftClick); says his businesses do \$4M+ a year combined	Door-to-door marketing first, then an AI writing agency. Realised copying a system he'd already built took 30 minutes and earned \$1,000, so he stopped doing custom jobs	Build one system really well, then sell the same thing to lots of similar businesses
Jordan Platten	UK agency Affluent.co, over \$1M a year; started in his early 20s	Taught himself Facebook ads fast, then went straight to local businesses: a restaurant, a furniture shop, a jeweller. First client within weeks	Local businesses are the easiest first clients. Give value up front, and hit daily outreach targets
Joy Hawkins	Sterling Sky, a local SEO agency; Google Business Profile Product Expert since the 2000s	Became the go-to person on one narrow thing: Google profiles	Reviews need to come in steadily every week, not in bursts. That's your monthly service

Person	What they built (their own claims)	What they did at the start	What you copy
Darren Shaw	Whitespark, publishes the yearly Local Search Ranking Factors survey	Built tools and research around local search	Reviews and the Google profile are among the biggest things that decide who shows up on Maps. That's your sales pitch, backed by data
Alex Hormozi	Author of \$100M Offers	Built gyms, then a business selling to gym owners	Make an offer that's hard to say no to: big result, high chance it works, fast, no effort for them
Liam Ottley	Runs a large AI automation agency community	Recommends beginners pick a niche, use Hormozi's offer steps, and set up systems free at first for case studies	Free pilots for proof first, then charge properly

The pattern

Look at what they've got in common. None of them started with a big idea. They picked one boring problem and got good at it, then did loads of outreach before anyone knew who they were. Their first clients were small and local, and they gave work away early to get proof. Saraev did door-to-door. Platten rang restaurants. That's your Thursday walk-ins.

One more thing you should know. Most of these people now make their biggest money selling courses and communities to people like you, not from client work. Saraev's figures say his Maker School community brings in more than his agency does. That doesn't make them wrong, but take the free lessons and skip the expensive courses. You've got paying clients to go and get.

What not to do

The ones that can get you or your client in real trouble:

1. Don't write, buy or arrange fake reviews, ever, not even "just a couple to get them started." Since 6 April 2025 it's banned outright in the UK under the DMCC Act, and that includes offering a service that helps publish them. Fines can reach 10% of global

turnover.

2. Don't hide or bury bad reviews, or only show off the good ones. UK guidance treats that as misleading consumers too.
3. Don't "review gate." That's sending happy customers to Google and unhappy ones to a private form. Google's policy doesn't allow businesses to selectively ask for positive reviews. Send the same review link to everyone.
4. Don't offer discounts or freebies in exchange for reviews. Incentivised reviews break Google's rules and must be disclosed under UK law.
5. Don't post rude or argumentative replies, even if the review's unfair. Google now lets anyone report owner responses, and bad ones can get pulled or the profile restricted.
6. Don't text people who never asked to hear from the business. Under PECR, automated follow-ups are only for people who've enquired or are customers.
7. Don't ask for Owner access to a client's Google profile. Manager is all you need.

The ones that waste your time and money:

1. Don't buy a £1,000+ "AI agency" course. Everything you need is free, and the people selling those courses mostly make their money from courses.
2. Don't spend week 1 on a logo, a fancy website or business cards with gold foil. Nobody's buying your logo.
3. Don't build custom one-off systems for every client. Saraev's big lesson: build one thing, then copy it.
4. Don't chase every type of business. Pick one or two niches and get known for them.
5. Don't post AI replies without reading them. One reply thanking a plumber's customer for "a lovely stay" and you've lost the client.
6. Don't promise rankings or "page one of Google." Promise the work (every review answered within 48 hours, weekly posts) and show the results.
7. Don't give away more than 2 free pilots. After that, everyone pays.
8. Don't quit after the first 20 no's. Platten's and Saraev's stories are mostly about volume and not stopping.
9. Don't let it eat your daughter days. Burnout kills more side businesses than competition does.

Where to look

For clients

Where	What you're looking for
Google Maps	Search "barber Narborough Road," "roofer Wigston" etc. Sort reviews by newest and count the ones with no owner reply. Your main hunting ground.
Checkatrade, Rated People, MyBuilder	Trades in Leicestershire with £5k+ jobs, for the automation pitch later
Meta Ad Library (free)	Local businesses already paying for ads. They spend on marketing, so they'll pay you.
Local Facebook groups (Leicester Business Network type groups, area community pages)	Owners asking for recommendations, and tradesmen advertising themselves
Your own street	Every barber, cafe and garage you already use. Easiest first conversation you'll ever have.
Your clients	Ask every happy client "Who else do you know who'd want this?" Owners know owners.

For learning (all free)

What	Where
Google profiles and reviews	Sterling Sky blog (sterlingsky.ca) and Whitespark's reviews guide (whitespark.ca)
Which things move Google Maps rankings	Whitespark's Local Search Ranking Factors report
Google's own review rules	Google Maps User Contributed Content Policy, "Prohibited and restricted content" page
UK review law	CMA guidance on fake reviews (search "CMA fake reviews DMCC guidance")

What	Where
Automations	Make Academy (academy.make.com), plus Nick Saraev's free YouTube videos on Make.com
Offers and selling	\$100M Offers by Alex Hormozi (book or audiobook, under £15)
Texting and data rules	ICO website, PECR and "electronic and telephone marketing" guidance

For tools

Claude or ChatGPT for writing, Canva for audits and posts, Google Sheets for tracking, Make.com for automations, Carrd for a one-page site, Stripe or GoCardless for payments. That's the whole kit.

The exact details to learn

Tick these off as you learn them. If you can explain each one to a shop owner in one sentence, you know enough to sell.

Google profiles (weeks 1 and 2)

- ☐ The difference between Owner and Manager access, and how a client adds you (Business Profile settings, then People and access)
- ☐ A profile must be verified before the owner can reply to reviews
- ☐ Reviews and the profile itself are among the top things deciding who shows on Google Maps (Whitespark survey)
- ☐ Steady new reviews every week beat a burst of 30 in one month (Sterling Sky testing on review recency)
- ☐ Photos are one of the strongest profile signals, so new real photos every month matter
- ☐ The primary category is the most important box on the profile. Get it exactly right ("Barber shop," not "Hair salon" for a barber).
- ☐ Where to find the Performance numbers (calls, directions, website clicks) for your monthly report
- ☐ How to make a review link and turn it into a QR code
- ☐ Anyone can now report a rude owner reply, so every reply stays calm and polite

UK rules (week 2, one evening)

- ☐ DMCC Act, from 6 April 2025: fake reviews, hidden incentivised reviews and services that help publish them are banned
- ☐ Don't present only the good reviews or suppress the bad ones
- ☐ Google's policy: no review gating, no incentives, same link for everyone
- ☐ PECR: automated marketing texts only to people who enquired or bought
- ☐ UK GDPR basics: you're handling customers' names and numbers, so keep them on the client's systems, not your phone
- ☐ HMRC: register as a sole trader; the first £1,000 a year of trading income is covered by the trading allowance

Selling (every week, this is the big one)

- ☐ Hormozi's value equation: value goes up when the result is big and likely, and down when it's slow or needs effort. So your offer is: "Every review answered within 48 hours, nothing for you to do, see it working in 7 days."
- ☐ Your opener for each niche, word for word, practised out loud 20 times
- ☐ The 6 objections and your answers (they're in the review plan PDF)
- ☐ Follow-up rhythm: day 0, day 2, day 7. Most yeses come from the follow-up.
- ☐ How to ask for a referral without it being awkward

Make.com and automation (weeks 1 to 5, evenings)

- ☐ Words to know: scenario (a whole automation), trigger (what starts it), module (each step), webhook (a link a form sends data to), router (splits into paths), filter (only carries on if a rule is met), operations (what you pay for)
- ☐ Build: form filled in, then instant text, then a row added to a Google Sheet
- ☐ Build: a delay step for follow-ups after 2 days and after 7 days
- ☐ How to stop the follow-ups once someone books (a filter checking a "booked" column)
- ☐ The headline stat for your pitch: a Harvard Business Review study of about 1.25 million leads found firms replying within an hour were nearly 7 times more likely to qualify the lead than those replying later, and the average reply took 42 hours

Pricing maths (one evening)

- ☐ Work out what one customer is worth to each niche. A barber regular at £20 every 4 weeks is about £260 a year. One kitchen job is £8,000 to £15,000.
- ☐ Then your pitch writes itself: "I'm £129 a month. If I bring you one extra regular every couple of months, I've paid for myself."

- ☐ Your costs per client (AI subscription share, Make.com operations, texts) so you know your profit on every deal

Sources

- [Nick Saraev biography](#)
- [Starter Story: Jordan Platten and Affluent.co](#)
- [Jordan Platten on Goodreads](#)
- [Sterling Sky \(Joy Hawkins\)](#) and [Joy Hawkins on review recency](#)
- [Whitespark Local Search Ranking Factors](#) and [Whitespark reviews guide](#)
- [Google Maps prohibited and restricted content policy](#)
- [Google's rules on incentivised reviews \(ApplauseHQ\)](#)
- [CMS: the DMCC Act bans fake reviews](#)
- [Harvard Business Review: The Short Life of Online Sales Leads \(2011\)](#)
- [\\$100M Offers summary \(Scalabl\)](#)
- [Liam Ottley's beginner strategy](#)